THE REMOTE SUPPORT PROGRAM · JOB SHEET

Set up DKIM email signing for theremotesupportprogram.com

Get xneelo to sign our outgoing mail, publish the matching key in Cloudflare, and prove it works. Most of the job is waiting for a support reply; the work itself is one DNS record and one test email.

Version 1 · 16 September 2026 Owner: Clint, Anywhere IT queries@theremotesupportprogram.com

Why this matters

DKIM puts a cryptographic signature on every email we send. The receiving mail server checks that signature against a key published in our DNS, and so can tell a genuine message from a forged one.

Gmail and Microsoft have both tightened their rules. Mail from a domain with no DKIM is far more likely to be filed as spam or rejected outright — particularly from a domain that has not sent much before, which is exactly our position. **Our website's only contact route is an email address.** A reply to a prospect that lands silently in their junk folder is a lost sale we never hear about.

Where DKIM fits

Three standards work together. We have two of them already; you are adding the third.

STANDARD	WHAT IT DOES	OURS TODAY
SPF	Lists which servers are allowed to send mail for the domain.	**In place.** `v=spf1 mx a include:spf.host-h.net ~all`
DKIM	Signs each message, proving it really came from us and was not altered.	**Missing. This job.**
DMARC	Tells receivers what to do when a message fails SPF or DKIM.	**In place**, set to monitor only: `p=none`

Two systems, and they are not the same company

READ THIS BEFORE YOU START

Mail is hosted by xneelo. DNS is hosted by Cloudflare. They are separate, and this job touches both:

- The DKIM **key** comes from **xneelo** (konsoleH, or their support desk).
- The DKIM **record** is published in **Cloudflare**.

The domain is registered at Afrihost, but its nameservers point at Cloudflare, so **DNS changes made at Afrihost do nothing at all.** If you find yourself in Afrihost ClientZone editing DNS, stop.

1 Get the DKIM key from xneelo KONSOLEH, OR SUPPORT

Sign in to konsoleH at `https://konsoleh.xneelo.co.za` with the details Clint gave you and select `theremotesupportprogram.com`.

Look through the mail settings for a **DKIM** option. It may appear under a heading such as *Mail*, *Email* or *Advanced*. If it is there, enable it for the domain, and it will generate and show you two things you need to write down:

- the **selector** — a short name such as `default` or `x`
- the **public key** — a long block of letters and numbers

> **IF THERE IS NO DKIM OPTION IN KONSOLEH**
>
> That is common, and it is not a dead end. Log a support ticket with xneelo asking them to do it. Wording that gets a useful reply first time:
>
> ```
> Please enable DKIM signing for outgoing mail on the domain
> theremotesupportprogram.com, which is on your shared hosting
> (server www40.cpt3.host-h.net).
>
> Our DNS is hosted at Cloudflare, not with xneelo, so please send
> me the DKIM selector and the public key TXT record value and I
> will publish the record myself.
> ```
>
> That last paragraph matters. If they assume they control the DNS they will try to add the record themselves, find they cannot, and the ticket stalls.

Do not continue until you have both the selector and the key. Without them there is nothing to publish.

2 Publish the record in Cloudflare `DASH.CLOUDFLARE.COM`

Sign in to Cloudflare, open `theremotesupportprogram.com`, and go to **DNS → Records**. Add a record:

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Type	`TXT`
Name	`SELECTOR._domainkey` — replacing `SELECTOR` with the one xneelo gave you. If the selector is `x`, the name is `x._domainkey`.
Content	The value xneelo gave you. It starts `v=DKIM1;` and ends with a very long `p=` section.
TTL	Leave on Auto.

GETTING THE VALUE IN EXACTLY RIGHT

- Paste it as **one continuous line**. If your text editor or the ticket wrapped it across several lines, join them back up and remove the line breaks.
- Do **not** add quotation marks around it. Cloudflare adds those itself. A pasted pair of quotes becomes part of the key and breaks it.
- Do not add spaces. The `p=` section is one unbroken run of characters.
- If xneelo sent the whole line including the record name, paste only the part from `v=DKIM1` onwards into Content.

DO NOT CHANGE ANYTHING ELSE IN CLOUDFLARE

You are **adding** one record. Do not edit or delete the MX record, the existing SPF record, or any of the A records.

A domain may only have one SPF record. If you add a second one, mail from this domain starts failing at every receiver — the opposite of what this job is for. Ours already exists and is correct. Leave it alone.

3 Check the record is live ON ANY WINDOWS PC

Give it a few minutes, then open Command Prompt and run this, replacing `SELECTOR` with the real one:

```
nslookup -type=TXT SELECTOR._domainkey.theremotesupportprogram.com
```

You should get back a line starting `"v=DKIM1;` followed by the long key. If you see *Non-existent domain*, or nothing at all, the record has not published — check the Name field is `SELECTOR._domainkey` and not something else.

USEFUL COMPARISON

These two already work and will answer, so you can use them to confirm the command itself is right before blaming the new record:

```
nslookup -type=TXT theremotesupportprogram.com
nslookup -type=TXT _dmarc.theremotesupportprogram.com
```

4 Prove that mail is actually signed THE STEP THAT MATTERS

A published record is not proof. It only means the key is *available* — the mail server still has to be signing with it. Test it properly:

1. Sign in to webmail at `https://webmail.xneelo.com` as `queries@theremotesupportprogram.com`.
2. Send an email to a **Gmail** address — your own is fine.
3. Open it in Gmail. Click the three dots at the top right of the message and choose **Show original**.

At the top you will see three lines. You want all three to say **PASS**:

```
SPF:    PASS
DKIM:   PASS
DMARC:  PASS
```

IF DKIM SAYS FAIL OR DOES NOT APPEAR AT ALL

Not appearing usually means xneelo has not switched signing on at their end, even if they gave you a key. Go back to the ticket and say the record is published but messages are arriving unsigned.

FAIL usually means the key in Cloudflare does not match the one signing the mail — most often a line break, a stray space, or added quotes in the Content field. Check step 2 again.

5 Point the DMARC reports somewhere real CLOUDFLARE

Our DMARC record currently reads:

```
v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:info@theremotesupportprogram.com
```

Those reports go to `info@`, which may not be a mailbox that exists. Check in konsoleH whether `info@theremotesupportprogram.com` is a real mailbox.

- **If it exists**, leave the record alone and tell Clint it is fine.
- **If it does not**, edit the `_dmarc` TXT record in Cloudflare and change that address to `queries@theremotesupportprogram.com`, changing nothing else on the line.

> **WHAT THESE REPORTS ARE**
>
> Other mail providers send a daily summary of mail they saw claiming to be from our domain, and whether it passed. They are how you find out if someone is spoofing us — worth having arrive somewhere a person looks.

Hand back to Clint

Tell him these five things

- [ ] The **selector** xneelo issued, and whether it came from konsoleH or a support ticket.
- [ ] That `nslookup` returns the DKIM record.
- [ ] What Gmail's **Show original** said for all three: SPF, DKIM and DMARC.
- [ ] Whether `info@theremotesupportprogram.com` exists, and whether you changed the DMARC address.
- [ ] The date you finished, so the key's age is known if it ever has to be rotated.

Not part of this job

Do not tighten DMARC. Once DKIM has been passing for a few weeks, the `p=none` in the DMARC record can become `p=quarantine`, which is what actually stops a spoofed message reaching anyone. Doing that too early, or while DKIM is failing, sends our own legitimate mail to spam. **That is Clint's call, on a later date, not part of this job.**

If something goes wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS
xneelo says DKIM is not available on shared hosting	Ask them to escalate, and tell Clint. Do not try to work around it.
`nslookup` says non-existent domain	The record name is wrong. It must be `SELECTOR._domainkey` — the `_domainkey` part is required and the underscore is part of it.
Gmail shows DKIM: FAIL	The published key does not match the signature. Almost always a line break, a space, or quotes added to the Content field.
Mail stops arriving at any point	Something was changed that should not have been. Check whether a second SPF record was added, or an MX record edited. Tell Clint immediately.